

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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A series of reflections from the Song of Solomon and the love relationship between two betrothed persons – a Bridegroom and a Bride to be –

[Series Three]

Our focus: Observing some of the spiritual truths and lessons learned from their love journey together.

Our passage: *Song of Solomon 5:6 I opened for my beloved, But my beloved had turned away and was gone. My heart leaped up when he spoke. I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer. NKJV*

Previously our focus:

Addressing love's hesitations and distractions

Song of Solomon 5:5 I arose to open for my beloved, and my hands dripped with myrrh, My fingers with liquid myrrh, On the handles of the lock. NKJV

Previously

IT WAS HER HESITATION AND PREOCCUPATION WITH SELF that caused her lover to turn away and remove himself from seeking to be WITH her.

OUR FOCUS TODAY:

Addressing THE CASUAL LOVE'S FAILURE LOSES & DISAPPOINTMENTS

Song of Solomon 5:6 I opened for my beloved, but my beloved had turned away and was gone. My heart leaped up when he spoke. I sought him, but I could not find him; I called him, but he gave me no answer.

Summary

THE WOMAN OPENED TO HER BELOVED – BUT HE HAD **TURNED AWAY AND WAS GONE.**

What a tragic moment that was.

His love for her was clearly expressed in his actions of knocking, his voice appealing to her and then attempting to reach for the door latch and open it himself.

HER DIFFICULTY

SHE RESPONDED - BUT **TOO LATE**

HER LOVER HAD **GONE** – AND HE HAD **TURNED AWAY - REMOVED HIMSELF**

APPLICATION 1.

now some of the things that she personally struggled with could be something that many believers experience especially only responding to God's promptings when convenient to us.

- This is something that we also must address in our lives; to readily responding to God when he appeals to us.

How tragic it is to read those word "I called him, and he gave no answer.

Delayed prayers

- How often have we prayed and there has been no immediate answer – **only silence?**
- **How have we all struggled and wrestled with this feeling?**
- It is like God has removed himself from us – he has **turned aside** – he is not there.
- We are left wondering why this is so?
- Have we unknowingly contributed to this?
- Is it our lack of responsiveness or possibly our delay to his promptings and appeals to us?

- Have we really recognized and understood his stirrings and that they are directed to us; or do we think that they are just thoughts coming from our own mind?
- Is it because we are asking the wrong things of him?
- Is it because he finds our requests meaningless and undefined?
- Now we are all aware that God is Always with us and that he hears our prayers if they are according to his will – BUT the response of this woman raises the very important question of **our attitude and behaviour towards God?**
- How often do we display a behaviour and attitude that his appeals and promptings are inconvenient and an interruption to our plans?
- Is there a need for us to show more reverence and devotedness in our responses to God, simply because he is LORD?
- Do we need to show more humility, accountability or dependence on him?

APPLICATION 2.

Regarding our desire for intimate fellowship with our Lord (lover) and the resulting challenges.

- In our hunger to have intimate fellowship / communion with our heavenly father and Jesus have we ever experienced what this lady went through.

I SOUGHT HIM - BUT FOUND HIM NOT

I SEARCHED FOR HIM – BUT COULD NOT FIND HIM

I CALLED HIM – BUT HE GAVE NO ANSWER

Questions to be asked

Q. Have we ever sought fellowship and communion with our Lover Jesus and Father God, and we felt that he has withdrawn himself from us?

Q. Was it our failure to respond to his knock and appeal the reason that we felt the sense of his presence was not there – somehow, he had withdrawn himself?

Q. Was it because we had not yet come to that place in our lives where we had surrendered to Christ in such a way that we were eagerly waiting for the sound of his knock, his voice. ***“My sheep hear my voice”?***

Comment made. OFTEN it is DIFFICULT TO FIND fellowship and intimate communion with God in the midst of being faithful and accountable to those things that been entrusted to us.

Q. Has this been our experience; and if so, is it often that way with you?

Q. What can we learn from that and how can we address / correct that from happening in our lives because it is a horrible feeling to experience, he has withdrawn himself and he does not answer.

- **CHANGE OUR DAILY SCHEDULE TO INCLUDE TIME WITH GOD WITH NO INTERRUPTIONS.**
- Practice it daily even if you don't get anything tangible from it.
- Practice it UNTIL it becomes a habit.
- practice it until you are able to sense communion with him.

My personal testimony as a brand-new Christian

One Indigenous Australian (aboriginal) preacher taught me about some principles to follow when having time with God.

HE SAID: THERE ARE THREE THINGS THAT **HINDER PRAYER AND COMMUNION WITH GOD.**

1. THE FIRST IS – **INTERRUPTIONS.** (people, things especially phones)
2. THE NEXT IS – **SLEEPINESS.** (feeling tired etc)
3. THE THIRD IS - **A WANDERING MIND.** - (thinking of this and that)

HIS SOLUTION TO THESE THREE THINGS

1. **HIDE YOURSELF FROM PEOPLE** – find a place where no one or nothing will interrupt you.
2. **PRAY STANDING UP AND WALKING AROUND** – it is difficult to fall asleep while in that position.
3. **PRAY, TALK TO GOD ALOUD SO YOU CAN HEAR YOUR OWN VOICE** – it is difficult for your mind to wander off to other things if you are listening to what you are saying to God.

- So, phones completely turned off or don't bring it with you.
- No appointments – not available till after.

IF YOU PRACTICE THIS UNTIL IT BECOMES A HABIT - A NATURAL BEHAVIOURAL PATTERN OF YOUR LIFE - YOU WILL ENJOY INTIMATE AND MEANINGFUL FELLOWSHIP WITH YOUR LORD (LOVER).

Amen – Ps Barry